

Canadian Citizenship Application Checklist

A general-purpose checklist for organizing your application. Not affiliated with the Government of Canada or IRCC — always confirm current requirements at canada.ca.

1. Confirm Basic Eligibility

- ☐ You are a permanent resident of Canada (not under a removal order).
- ☐ You have been physically present in Canada for at least 1,095 days within the 5 years right before applying.
- ☐ You have filed income taxes, if required, for at least 3 of the last 5 years.
- ☐ You have met the language requirement (adequate English or French) if you are aged 18–54.
- ☐ You have not been prohibited from citizenship under the Citizenship Act (certain criminal or immigration issues can affect this).

2. Gather Required Documents

- ☐ Permanent Resident (PR) card or confirmation of permanent residence.
- ☐ Valid passport or travel document(s) covering the last 5 years.
- ☐ Proof of language ability (test results, or evidence of study/work in English or French), if applicable.
- ☐ Two citizenship photos meeting the official specifications.
- ☐ Proof of any legal name change, if applicable (marriage certificate, court order, etc.).
- ☐ Details of all travel outside Canada during the 5-year period (dates and destinations).

3. Complete the Application

- ☐ Fill out the citizenship application form completely and accurately.
- ☐ Double check all dates of travel and residence for consistency with your passport stamps and records.
- ☐ Pay the required application fee (confirm the current amount directly at canada.ca before paying — fees change periodically).
- ☐ Submit the application online through the IRCC secure portal, or by mail if instructed.

4. After You Apply

- ☐ Save your application confirmation and reference number somewhere safe.
- ☐ Watch for a request to complete the citizenship knowledge test, if you are aged 18–54.
- ☐ Prepare using a study guide covering the same topics as the official "Discover Canada" guide.
- ☐ Watch for an interview notice, if IRCC requests one.
- ☐ Once approved, watch for your invitation to a citizenship ceremony and the Oath of Citizenship.

5. After Becoming a Citizen

- ☐ Apply for a Canadian passport, if desired.
- ☐ Register to vote in federal, provincial, and municipal elections.

~~check~~ Update your identification documents to reflect your new citizenship status, if needed.

~~check~~ Check whether your country of origin requires you to formally renounce or report your new citizenship.

This checklist is a general study aid and does not replace official guidance. Requirements, fees, and processing steps can change — always verify current information directly at canada.ca before submitting your application.